

# ILAYDA B. ONDER

Texas A&M University  
Department of Political Science  
3046 Allen Building  
College Station, TX 77840

EMAIL [ilaydaonder@tamu.edu](mailto:ilaydaonder@tamu.edu)  
WEBSITE [ilaydaonder.com](http://ilaydaonder.com)  
ORCID [0000-0002-5712-8131](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5712-8131)  
[Google Scholar](#)

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2024 – Present | **Texas A&M University**  
Assistant Professor of Political Science  
Bush School of Government and Public Service

## EDUCATION

2024 | **The Pennsylvania State University**  
Ph.D. in Political Science  
Fields: *International Relations, Political Methodology*  
Dissertation: *Cooperation, Infighting, and Diffusion in Militant Group Networks*  
– Winner of the USIP-Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellowship

2018 | **Koc University**  
M.A. in International Relations  
Fellowships: *TUBITAK MSc/MA Scholarship*

2016 | **Koc University**  
M.A. in International Relations  
Fellowships: *Semahat Arsel Scholar & Vehbi Koç Scholar*

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study political violence, rebellion, and civil war with a focus on (1) rebel-civilian ties, (2) rebel public communication, (3) multi-party conflicts, and (4) rebel intra-group politics.

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Rebel Intra-Group Politics

- 11 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2026. “A Principal-Agent Theory and Network Analysis of High-End Cooperation Among Militant Groups.” *Political Science Research and Methods*. Accepted Pending Replication.<sup>MP, RC</sup>
- 10 | Berlin, Mark, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “Leadership Succession and Jihadist Beheadings.” *Journal of Global Security Studies*. Forthcoming.<sup>IG</sup>
- 9 | Berlin, Mark, and **Ilayda B. Onder**. 2026. “Beyond Outbidding: Armed Group Responses to Transnational Jihadist Competition.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. Online First.<sup>MP</sup>

- 8 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2026. “Quantitative Premises and Challenges in Studying the Kurdish Conflict in Turkey.” *PS: Political Science & Politics*. Forthcoming.<sup>RC, IG</sup>  
 – Invited peer-reviewed contribution to the symposium “The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict: Insights from the Kurdish Case”
- 7 | Amjad, Maria, Mark Berlin, Sara Daub, **Ilayda B. Onder**, and Joshua Fawcett Weiner. 2026. “Commanders of the Mujahideen: Introducing the Jihadist Leaders Dataset.” *Journal of Peace Research* 63(2): 289–297.<sup>IG</sup>
- 6 | **Onder, Ilayda B.**, and Mark Berlin. 2026. “We Have Nothing to Do with It: How Statements of Denial by Armed Actors Shape Public Perceptions and Emotions.” *Political Psychology* 47(3): e70079.<sup>PC</sup>
- 5 | **Onder, Ilayda B.**, Nazli Avdan, and Aaron M. Hoffman. 2025. “Credit Claims and the Survival Rates of Terrorist Organizations.” *International Interactions* 51(6): 1050–1066.<sup>PC</sup>
- 4 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2025. “How Civilian Loyalties Shape Rebel-led Victimization of Rebel Constituencies.” *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 69(4): 701–730.<sup>RC</sup>
- 3 | Loyle, Cianne E., and **Ilayda B. Onder**. 2024. “The Legacies of Rebel Rule in Southeast Turkey.” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(11): 1771–1803.<sup>RC</sup>
- 2 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2024. “Target Hardening and Non-State Armed Groups’ Target Selection: Evidence from India.” *Terrorism and Political Violence* 36(8): 1105–1126.<sup>MP</sup>
- 1 | **Onder, Ilayda B.** 2023. “Signaling Resolve through Credit-claiming.” *International Interactions* 49(5): 755–784.<sup>PC</sup>  
 – Winner of the Raymond E. Lombra and Roberta Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award

## RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

RC = Rebel-Civilian Ties | PC = Rebel Public Communication | MP = Multi-Party Conflicts | IG = Rebel Intra-Group Politics

\*Indicates graduate student co-author. \*\*Indicates undergraduate student co-author.

### *Under Review/Submitted*

- | Performative Rebel Governance and Legibility: Evidence from Rebel Recruitment in Southeast Turkey. Invited to revise & resubmit at the *American Political Science Review*.<sup>RC</sup>
- | Introducing the Rebel Internal Governance Dataset (with Hongbi Choi\*). Invited to revise & resubmit at *International Studies Quarterly*.<sup>IG</sup>
- | Kin-Soldier Martyrs and Incumbent Electoral Support in Rebel Constituencies: Evidence from Lottery-Based Conscription in Turkey.<sup>RC</sup>
- | Right-Wing Populism and Counterterrorism Preferences: The Roles of Strongman Rule, Outgroup Attitudes, and Conspiratorial Thinking in Shaping Policy Support in the United States. (with James Piazza)<sup>PC</sup>
- | Introducing the Rebel Lobbying Dataset (with Yu Bin Kim)<sup>PC</sup>

## *In Progress*

- | When Constituencies Unite but Recruitment Competition Divides: Cooperation and Infighting Among Armed Groups. *Draft in progress.*<sup>MP, RC</sup>
- | Inter-Group Learning and Diffusion in Militant Alliances. *Draft in progress.*<sup>MP</sup>
- | Civilian Victimization by Governance-Oriented Rebels. (with Hongbi Choi\*) *Draft in progress.*<sup>IG, RC</sup>
- | Repression of Rebel Constituencies and Rebel Recruitment. (with Muge Acarlar\*) *Draft in progress.*<sup>RC</sup>
- | Female Fighters and Rebel Compliance with International Humanitarian Law. (with Merve Keskin, Yu Bin Kim, and Blair Welsh) *Draft in progress.*<sup>PC, RC</sup>
- | Kidnapping and the Consolidation of Rebel Rule: Evidence from Iraq and Syria, 2014–2016. (with Mark Berlin and Tim Jones) *Draft in progress.*<sup>RC</sup>
- | Leadership Succession and Social Service Provision in Rebel Groups. (with Joshua Fawcett Weiner and Mark Berlin) *Draft in progress.*<sup>IG, RC</sup>
- | Focusing on the Who: Rebel Governing Arrangements and International Legitimacy. (with Yu Bin Kim and Gidong Kim) *Data analysis in progress.*<sup>RC</sup>
- | Part-Time Rebels. *Data analysis in progress.*<sup>RC, IG</sup>
- | Opportunistic Rebel Violence against Civilians, How Groups Sanction It, and Foreign Public Opinion. (with Hongbi Choi\*) *Data collection in progress.*<sup>IG</sup>
- | Denial in Rebellion (with Mark Berlin and Kate Willey\*\*) *Data collection in progress.*<sup>PC</sup>
- | Inter-Group Mobility in Conflict. (with Finn Klebe) *Data collection in progress.*<sup>MP</sup>

## GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

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|                                                                          |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Texas A&amp;M University</b>                                          |             |
| Bush School Seed Grant Program, \$11,990                                 | 2025        |
| Glasscock Faculty Research Fellowship, \$5,000                           | 2025        |
| Scowcroft Faculty Research Grant Award, \$2,400                          | 2025        |
| <b>The Empirical Studies of Conflict, Princeton University</b>           |             |
| ESOC Mentorship Program, Non-monetary                                    | 2024 — 2025 |
| <b>Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil War, University of York</b> |             |
| Civil War Paths Fellow, Non-monetary                                     | 2024        |
| <b>USIP-Minerva Research Initiative</b>                                  |             |
| Minerva Peace and Security Scholar Fellow, \$20,000                      | 2023 — 2024 |
| <b>The Pennsylvania State University</b>                                 |             |
| Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, \$1,000                      | 2024        |
| Summer Graduate Research Award, \$16,000                                 | 2020 — 2023 |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Outstanding Political Science Graduate Student, \$1,500                        | 2022 |
| RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2,000                                             | 2021 |
| Program in Empirical International Relations Fellowship, Assistantship Release | 2021 |
| Jesse M. MacKnight Memorial Graduate Scholarship, \$2,000                      | 2018 |

## TEACHING

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|                                                                                                                                     |                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Texas A&amp;M University</b>                                                                                                     |                         |
| Introduction to Political Science Research (Undergraduate)                                                                          | Fall 2024, Fall 2025    |
| Ethnic Conflict (Undergraduate)                                                                                                     | Spring 2026             |
| Conflict Studies (Graduate)                                                                                                         | Fall 2026               |
| <i>Ph.D. Advisory and Dissertation Committees:</i> Hongbi Choi; Muge Acarlar; Julia Reyes; Santiago Vidal Calvo; Nathaniel Williams |                         |
| <b>The Pennsylvania State University</b>                                                                                            |                         |
| International Relations Theory (Undergraduate)                                                                                      | Spring 2024             |
| Quantitative Political Analysis (Undergraduate)                                                                                     | Fall 2023               |
| Graduate Methods Preceptor                                                                                                          | Fall 2021 – Spring 2022 |

## CONFERENCE, WORKSHOP, AND COLLOQUIUM PRESENTATIONS

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|                                                            |                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| American Political Science Association                     | 2023, 2024                         |
| International Studies Association                          | 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 |
| Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop          | 2023                               |
| Midwest Political Science Association                      | 2019, 2023                         |
| NYU-CESS Experimental Political Science Conference         | 2024                               |
| Online Peace Science Colloquium                            | 2021                               |
| Peace Science Society (International)                      | 2020, 2021, 2023, 2025             |
| Political Networks Online Colloquium                       | 2023                               |
| Rabin Graduate Conference (Hebrew University of Jerusalem) | 2017                               |
| Texas Triangle IR Conference                               | 2025, 2026                         |

## INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

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|                                                              |               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <i>The Clash of Methods in Studying Ethnic Conflict</i>      |               |
| Peace Science Conference, University of Central Florida      | November 2025 |
| <i>New Frontiers in Research on Terrorism and Civil Wars</i> |               |
| University of Houston                                        | March 2025    |
| <i>Rising Scholars Workshop</i>                              |               |
| Peace Science Conference, Washington University St. Louis    | November 2023 |

## DATASETS

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Jihadist Leaders Dataset (JLD)</a>                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Data on 31 biographical attributes of 238 leaders from 110 jihadist groups across Africa, Asia, and the Middle East between 1976 and 2023, drawing on Arabic, English, French, German, Turkish, and Urdu sources. |

#### Northeast Indian Militant Group Networks Dataset

Network dataset of 53 ethnonationalist militant groups active in Northeast India from 1981 through 2021, coding 8 forms of cooperation: joint operations, training, arms and funds, intelligence-sharing and logistical support, joint planning and meetings, joint public statements, umbrella organizations, and rhetorical support.

#### Civilian Victimization in the Kurdish Insurgency Dataset

572 incidents of the PKK's coercive acts, targeting or unintentionally harming civilian bystanders in 21 provinces in southeastern Turkey with significant Kurdish-speaking populations between 2014-2019, recording the characteristics of individuals (e.g., public worker, politician, alleged state informant, business owner).

#### Rebel Internal Governance (RIG) Dataset

(In development)

Time-variant data on 14 internal institutions and practices of 166 rebel groups across 57 countries between 1990 and 2012, capturing both written and de facto regulatory frameworks, judicial procedures, and disciplinary practices used to regulate fighter behavior.

#### Denial and Rebuttal in Rebellion Dataset

(In development)

Data public statements issued by rebel groups in the sub-Saharan African, Middle East and North Africa, in which they refute allegations (e.g., affiliations with other non-state actors, the arrests of their members, the killings of their leaders, involvement in criminal activities) made by governments or media outlets.

## SERVICE

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### *Departmental Service*

|                                                                          |              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Graduate & Curriculum Committee, Texas A&M University                    | 2024–Present |
| Advisory Committee Graduate Student Rep., Penn State University          | 2023–2024    |
| Graduate Student Association of Political Science, Penn State University | 2019–2022    |

### *Chair/Discussant*

|                                        |            |
|----------------------------------------|------------|
| American Political Science Association | 2023       |
| International Studies Association      | 2025, 2026 |
| Texas Triangle IR Conference           | 2026       |

### *Workshop Organizer*

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|----------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict Workshop  | 2024–Present |
| Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop | 2023–2024    |

### *Reviewer*

*American Journal of Political Science* (x2), *American Political Science Review*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science* (x2), *Global Change, Peace & Security*, *International Interactions*, *International Studies Quarterly* (x3), *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, *Journal of Global Security Studies*, *Journal of Peace Research* (x2), *Journal of Politics*, *Network Science* (x2), *Palgrave Macmillan*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Security Studies*.

## PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

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American Political Science Association  
International Studies Association  
Peace Science Society (International)

Last updated: May 30, 2026